Kalbarri National Park, Western Australia, Off the Grid

Whoever refuted the theory of time travel has clearly never set foot in Kalbarri National Park. Defined by a sea of red sandstone that dates back millions of years to a time when the river carved out deep gorges on its way to the ocean, the landscape is striking. The soundtrack is bird life – the shriek of wedge-tailed eagles, for example, and the new friends are the kangaroos and emus. There are multiple walking trail options to get as deep into the park as you like. Just 500 metres from the car park is Nature's Window – a rock formation that neatly frames views of the Murchison River. The newly-opened Kalbarri Skywalk is an essential meander for the compelling views it throws up. You walk out along cantilevered viewing platforms, suspended 100 metres above the gorge. When the national park closes, head to the seaside town of Kalbarri for sunset. In the soft light, the coastal cliffs resemble a layered cake, easily seen along Pot Alley (a natural ocean gorge). Natural Bridge supplies beguiling coastal views, while Mushroom Rock lets you experience a variety of geological forms that look forged out of a sandstone subconscious. There's also the option to see other highlights of the area like the Hutt Lagoon Pink Lake (hot pink in hue owing to the presence of a carotenoid producing algae), and the rugged coast from above, on a Kalbarri scenic flight.



Golden beaches add to the beauty that is Kalbarri; The Hutt Lagoon Pink Lake owes its pink hue to the presence of a carotenoid producing algae (Top)